

— EDITION 33

I budget AI credits the way I would manage a cash position.

Deploying AI costs money per run. If you do not meter it, it drains quietly. I learned that the embarrassing way.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 07

| The setup.

The unglamorous truth about deploying AI: it costs money per run. Treat that cost as free and it will quietly drain the whole thing.

0202 / 07

| How I found out.

I'd planned a build assuming the image generation was unlimited and free. The unlimited tier had quietly expired. Every image was now metered.

0303 / 07

| The damage.

My balance dropped by a third in a single day of normal activity. A plan I'd called roughly zero cost was on track to starve the daily jobs before the next refresh.

0404 / 07

| A per-run cap.

Each daily job now has a hard ceiling on what it can spend. Go over, it draws down or drops to draft mode. It never silently burns the reserve.

0505 / 07

| A protected reserve.

A fixed pool is fenced off for the highest-value output. Nothing routine can touch it. Same logic as ring-fencing cash you've already promised elsewhere.

0606 / 07

Just in time, with a tripwire.

Don't pre-generate everything. Make the expensive asset only when it's going out. And if the balance crosses a line before a set date, that's a decision point, not a surprise.

0707 / 07

| Save this.

Know the burn rate. Protect the reserve.
Never let a routine process spend the money
you set aside for the important thing.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Found this **useful?**

Repost to share it, and follow Joseph Bankole for field notes from shipping AI into real stacks.

◆ Joseph Bankole